
METANAS.

Quick Start Guide

Everything you need to go from purchase to tagged footage in under 20 minutes.

Tag in minutes, find in seconds.

v13 | macOS 12+ | One-time purchase

BEFORE YOU START

What You Need

METANAS runs on your Mac and tags footage stored on your NAS. No cloud storage, no subscriptions, no footage uploaded anywhere.

ITEM	DETAILS
Mac	macOS 12 Monterey or later
NAS or Storage	Synology, QNAP, or any mounted folder
Footage	MP4, MOV, or ProRes clips on your NAS
Internet	Only for purchase, API setup, and AI tagging
Gemini API Key	Free from Google AI Studio

ZERO CLOUD. FULL CONTROL.

Your footage never leaves your network. METANAS processes everything locally on your Mac. The only internet connection needed is for Gemini AI to analyse thumbnail frames. Your original files are never uploaded.

01 Purchase METANAS

Head to assortcreative.com/metanas to purchase METANAS.

You will be redirected to **Gumroad** to complete your purchase. METANAS is a one-time purchase — no subscription.

After payment, Gumroad provides you with a **License Key** and a **ZIP download link**.

Copy your License Key and keep it ready — you will need it when you first open METANAS.



02 Download, Extract, and Install

Download the ZIP file from Gumroad and **extract** it.

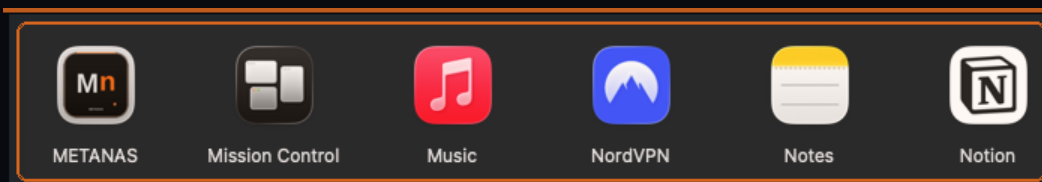
Drag **METANAS.app** into your **Applications** folder.

Open Applications and double-click METANAS to launch it.

If macOS blocks the app: go to **System Settings > Privacy & Security**, scroll down, and click **Open Anyway** where it says the app was blocked.

TIP: This security warning only appears because METANAS is in beta and has not yet been signed with Apple. There is no security risk — this will go away in a future release.

	build_dmg.sh	Yesterday at 12:06	6 KB	Plain Text
	METANAS	3 Apr 2026 at 14:24	369 KB	Application
	METANAS_Tutorial.pdf	3 Apr 2026 at 14:25	22 KB	PDF Document



03 First Run — Automatic Package Installation

On your first launch, METANAS opens **Terminal** to install all required packages for local metadata tagging.

Terminal will ask for your **Mac user password** to install packages. Type it and press Enter. Characters will not show as you type — that is normal.

METANAS installs: **Python 3.11**, **ffmpeg** (for video analysis), **openai-whisper** (for transcription), **google-generativeai** (for Gemini), **Flask** (for the browser UI), and **Pillow** (for image processing).

This only runs once. Future launches skip straight to the app.

TIP: If Homebrew is not installed, METANAS installs it automatically. The full setup takes 3 to 5 minutes depending on your internet speed.

No screenshot needed — Terminal runs automatically on first launch. Just type your password when prompted and wait for it to finish.

04 Activate Your License

After installation completes, METANAS opens in your **browser** automatically at `localhost:5000`.

Navigate to **Settings** and scroll to the bottom. Paste the **License Key** you received from Gumroad into the activation field.

Click **Save Settings** to activate METANAS. You will see a green **METANAS is activated** confirmation.

Lost your key? Check the receipt email from Gumroad.

MAC POWER

☐ **Caffeinate during tagging**
Prevents your Mac from sleeping while a tagging job is running. Automatically stops when the job finishes.

METADATA OUTPUT

Choose how metadata is saved after each clip is tagged. Both options can be on at the same time.

☒ **Write XMP sidecar files**
Creates a small .xmp file next to each video in the same folder. Think of it as a Post-it note attached to the clip — readable by Adobe Bridge, Premiere Pro, and DaVinci Resolve without touching the original video file. Safe to turn off if you don't use Adobe tools or want a clean folder.

☒ **Embed metadata into video files**
Writes the description, keywords, shot type, and camera movement directly inside the video file's metadata container (using ExifTool). The video image and audio are never touched — only the invisible metadata layer. This means the clip carries its tags with it wherever you copy it, and apps like QuickTime, VLC, and Finder's Get Info will show the description. Recommended on.

LICENSE & VERSION

METANAS is activated
Licensed to: tours@sheneller.com

Deactivate on this machine

Version 1.0.0 Up to date

Check for updates

Save Settings

05 Configure Your Settings

Gemini API Key — Go to aistudio.google.com/apikey, create a free API key, and paste it here. This powers the AI tagging. Click Save.

OpenAI API Key (optional) — If you prefer GPT-4o for vision, paste your OpenAI key from platform.openai.com/api-keys.

Default Provider — Choose between Gemini 2.5 Flash (recommended) or OpenAI GPT-4o for scene analysis.

Transcribe audio (Whisper) — Toggle on to auto-transcribe dialogue and narration in your clips.

Process image files — Enable to also tag JPG, PNG, and TIFF images alongside video.

Write XMP sidecar files — Recommended. Creates .xmp files that Premiere and Bridge can read.

Embed metadata into video files — Writes metadata directly into your video files using ExifTool.

TIP: The Gemini API free tier is generous — most users never need a paid plan. The API key is stored locally and never sent anywhere except Google's API.

Settings

API keys and configuration

VISION API KEYS

GEMINI API KEY

saved

Get yours at aistudio.google.com/apikey. Your key is stored locally and never sent anywhere except Google's API.

OPENAI API KEY

Get yours at platform.openai.com/api-keys. Your key is stored locally and never sent anywhere except OpenAI's API.

VISION PROVIDER

DEFAULT PROVIDER

Gemini 2.5 Flash (recommended)

▼

GEMINI MODEL

gemini-2.5-flash

OPENAI MODEL

gpt-4o

06 Point to Your Folder and Start Tagging

In the **Tag Footage** tab, click **Browse** and select the folder containing your footage.

METANAS scans the folder and lists every clip it finds — MP4, MOV, MXF, and ProRes files.

Choose your AI model (Gemini 2.5 Flash is default), set **Max Scenes/Clip**, and toggle **Re-process already tagged files** if needed.

Toggle **Save to main archive database** to add clips to your searchable archive.

Click **Start Tagging**. METANAS sends thumbnail frames to Gemini, gets descriptions back, and writes XMP metadata to your files.

TIP: With Whisper enabled, METANAS also transcribes spoken dialogue into searchable metadata.

The screenshot shows the METANAS Tag Footage interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation links: Dashboard, Tag Footage (active), Search, Script Source, History, and Settings. The main area is titled 'Tag Footage' and contains the following elements:

- FOLDER PATH:** A text field showing '/Volumes/Assort2025/Sheneller Projects/2026/MyProject' with a 'Browse' button to its right.
- Recent:** A row of recent project paths, including 'Videos for ADP', 'Media Images 2026', and two paths starting with '030526a_UberEatsReel_Footage'.
- VISION PROVIDER:** A dropdown menu currently set to 'Gemini 2.5 Flash'.
- Settings:** A section with several options:
 - A checkbox labeled 'When off, existing XMP files and DB records are never overwritten'.
 - PROJECT DATABASE:** A section with 'PROJECT DB FILENAME' set to 'auto-filled from folder name' and 'PROJECT DB SAVE LOCATION' set to 'footage-tagger/project_dbs/' with a 'Browse' button.
 - A note: 'Where this project's .db file will be saved — easy to share or archive per project'.
 - A toggle switch for 'Save to main archive database' which is currently turned on.
 - A note below the toggle: 'Turn off for test footage or one-off projects you don't want in your master archive'.
- Start Tagging:** A button to initiate the tagging process.
- How it works:** A section explaining the workflow:
 1. Extracts keyframes with scene detection
 2. Sends frames to your chosen AI vision model
 3. Transcribes audio (Whisper)
 4. Writes XMP sidecar + embeds metadata into the file
 5. Saves everything to the searchable database
- Cost:** A note at the bottom stating 'Gemini 2.5 Flash = \$0.01-0.05 per project'.

Orange boxes in the original image highlight the 'Browse' button next to the folder path, the 'Settings' section, the 'Save to main archive database' toggle, and the 'Start Tagging' button.

07 Search Your Archive

Click the **Search** tab in the sidebar to open the **Search Archive** page.

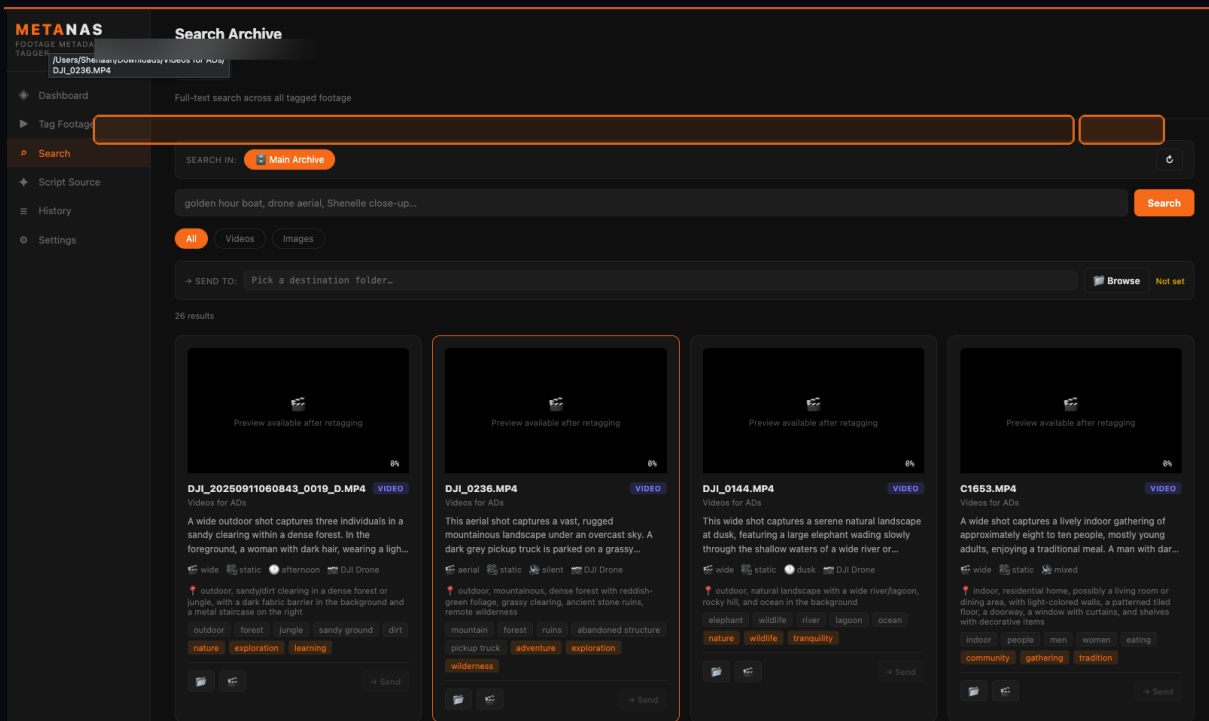
Type any keyword — `golden hour`, `wide shot`, `interview` — into the search bar and hit **Search**.

METANAS searches across all tagged clips in your archive. Results show thumbnails, descriptions, and file info.

Filter by **Footage**, **Photos**, or **All**. Click any result to locate the file instantly.

You can also open tagged footage in **Adobe Bridge** or **Premiere Pro** — search the Project panel for any keyword and find exactly the clips you need.

TIP: Final Cut Pro users: METANAS writes standard XMP, which most NLE metadata tools can read.



Done. Your clips are tagged. Search your archive, open Premiere, and find any shot in seconds.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Quick Fixes

Most issues resolve in under a minute. Here are the common ones.

PROBLEM	FIX
Gemini returns empty response	Check your API key in Settings. Regenerate if expired.
NAS folder not visible	Mount the NAS in Finder first. METANAS reads mounted folders.
ffprobe not found	Run <code>brew install ffmpeg</code> in Terminal and restart METANAS.
Tags not showing in Premiere	Re-import footage or refresh the project panel in Bridge.
Terminal asks for password	Type your Mac login password. Characters won't show — that's normal.
License key rejected	Copy the key from your Gumroad receipt email. No extra spaces.

TIPS

Get More from METANAS

- **Organise by project** — Point METANAS at one project folder at a time for cleaner, more relevant tags.
- **Use Whisper for interviews** — Turn on Whisper transcription in Settings. Every spoken word becomes searchable metadata.
- **Enable Person Recognition** — If your footage has recognisable faces, METANAS can identify and tag people automatically.
- **Check Bridge first** — Adobe Bridge gives you the richest view of your new XMP metadata. Use it to verify tags before editing.
- **Keep ffmpeg updated** — Run `brew upgrade ffmpeg` occasionally. METANAS uses ffprobe for file analysis.

Questions? Visit assortcreative.com/metanas or email support@assortcreative.com

Your footage. Your network. Tagged in minutes.